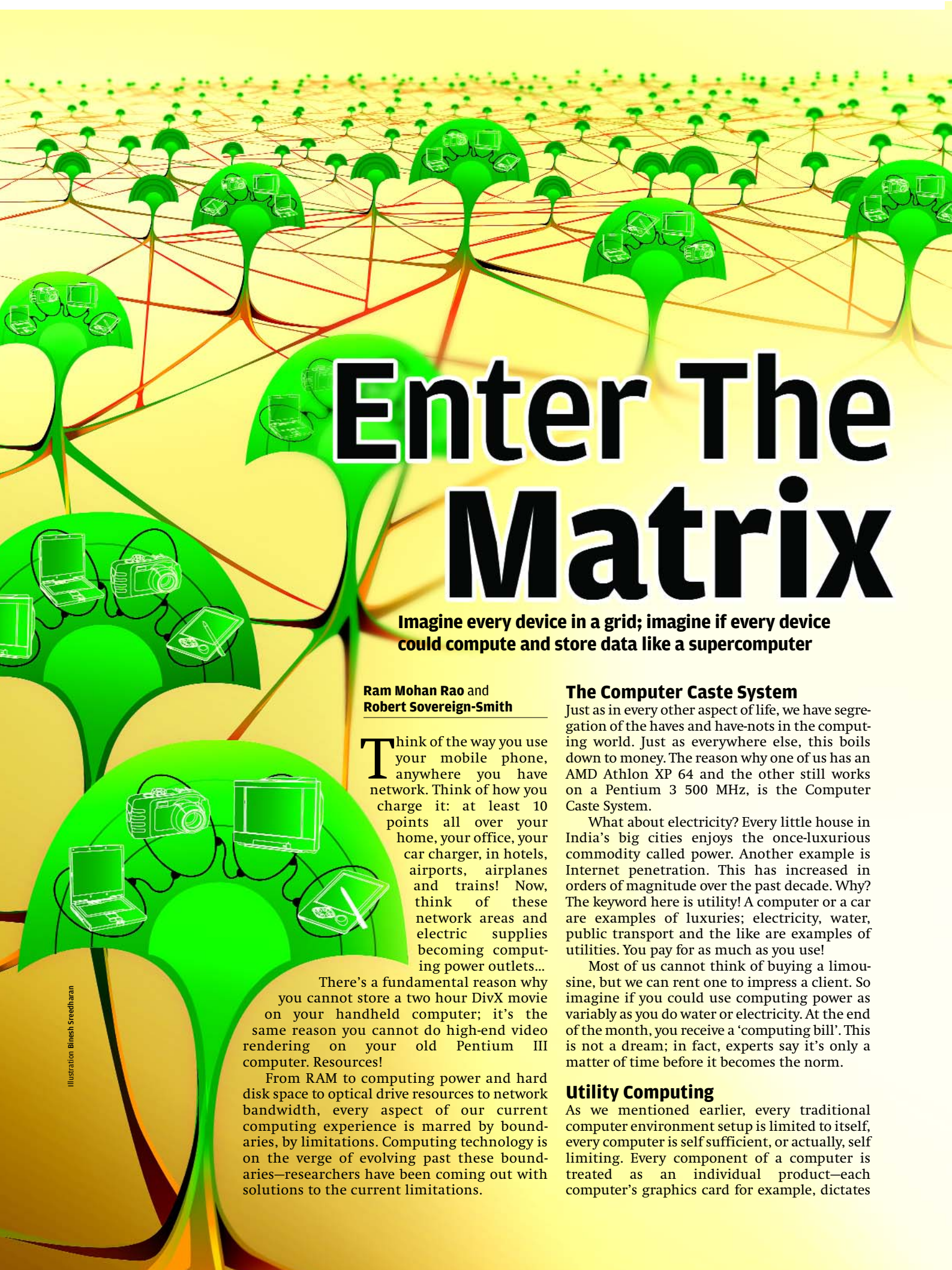




Enter The Matrix

Imagine every device in a grid; imagine if every device could compute and store data like a supercomputer

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Think of the way you use your mobile phone, anywhere you have network. Think of how you charge it: at least 10 points all over your home, your office, your car charger, in hotels, airports, airplanes and trains! Now, think of these network areas and electric supplies becoming computing power outlets...

There's a fundamental reason why you cannot store a two hour DivX movie on your handheld computer; it's the same reason you cannot do high-end video rendering on your old Pentium III computer. Resources!

From RAM to computing power and hard disk space to optical drive resources to network bandwidth, every aspect of our current computing experience is marred by boundaries, by limitations. Computing technology is on the verge of evolving past these boundaries—researchers have been coming out with solutions to the current limitations.

The Computer Caste System

Just as in every other aspect of life, we have segregation of the haves and have-nots in the computing world. Just as everywhere else, this boils down to money. The reason why one of us has an AMD Athlon XP 64 and the other still works on a Pentium 3 500 MHz, is the Computer Caste System.

What about electricity? Every little house in India's big cities enjoys the once-luxurious commodity called power. Another example is Internet penetration. This has increased in orders of magnitude over the past decade. Why? The keyword here is utility! A computer or a car are examples of luxuries; electricity, water, public transport and the like are examples of utilities. You pay for as much as you use!

Most of us cannot think of buying a limousine, but we can rent one to impress a client. So imagine if you could use computing power as variably as you do water or electricity. At the end of the month, you receive a 'computing bill'. This is not a dream; in fact, experts say it's only a matter of time before it becomes the norm.

Utility Computing

As we mentioned earlier, every traditional computer environment setup is limited to itself, every computer is self sufficient, or actually, self limiting. Every component of a computer is treated as an individual product—each computer's graphics card for example, dictates